

Create a custom example selector

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In this tutorial, we'll create a custom example selector that selects every alternate example from a given list of examples.

An `ExampleSelector` must implement two methods:

1. An `add_example` method which takes in an example and adds it into the `ExampleSelector`
2. A `select_examples` method which takes in input variables (which are meant to be user input) and returns a list of examples to use in the few shot prompt.

Let's implement a custom `ExampleSelector` that just selects two examples at random.

Note

Take a look at the current set of example selector implementations supported in LangChain [here](#).

Implement custom example selector

```
from langchain.prompts.example_selector.base import BaseExampleSelector
from typing import Dict, List
import numpy as np
```

```
class CustomExampleSelector(BaseExampleSelector):
```

```
    def __init__(self, examples: List[Dict[str, str]]):
```

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```

def add_example(self, example: Dict[str, str]) -> None:
    """Add new example to store for a key."""
    self.examples.append(example)

def select_examples(self, input_variables: Dict[str, str]) ->
List[dict]:
    """Select which examples to use based on the inputs."""
    return np.random.choice(self.examples, size=2, replace=False)

```

Use custom example selector

```

examples = [
    {"foo": "1"},
    {"foo": "2"},
    {"foo": "3"}
]

# Initialize example selector.
example_selector = CustomExampleSelector(examples)

# Select examples
example_selector.select_examples({"foo": "foo"})
# -> array([{'foo': '2'}, {'foo': '3'}], dtype=object)

# Add new example to the set of examples
example_selector.add_example({"foo": "4"})
example_selector.examples
# -> [{'foo': '1'}, {'foo': '2'}, {'foo': '3'}, {'foo': '4'}]

# Select examples
example_selector.select_examples({"foo": "foo"})
# -> array([{'foo': '1'}, {'foo': '4'}], dtype=object)

```